Gov essay: what to review tonight

Summative Mon Nov 2, period 2, 9:00, Room 506

You have about three hours before bed. Most of it goes into filling out the three blank worksheets in this packet from memory, because that's the same thinking the essay asks for.

Tonight

☐	**7:30**	Take the gov diagnostic, no notes, then grade it.	15 min
☐	**7:50**	Prompt 1 sheet from memory. Then check it against the filled in PDF and fix every miss in a different color.	25 min
☐	**8:15**	Prompt 2 sheet, same way.	25 min
☐	**8:40**	Break.	10 min
☐	**8:50**	Prompt 3 sheet, same way.	25 min
☐	**9:15**	Timed essay on the prompt that felt weakest, on the practice page, with only your zine and post-its. Check it with the rubric.	40 min
☐	**9:55**	Finish the key terms sheet, you hand it in tomorrow. Write the three post-its if they aren't done.	20 min
☐	**10:15**	Pack the zine, the post-its and the key terms sheet. Bed at 10:30.	15 min

What you need to know cold

- ☐ The thesis formula, [Claim] because [Argument 1] and [Argument 2], and the five paragraphs: intro with 3 context sentences, two TEA body paragraphs, the alternative perspective, the conclusion.
- ☐ All three theses, word for word. They're on the back of each filled in sheet.
- ☐ Two pieces of evidence per body paragraph for each prompt, with a year or a clause attached.
- ☐ Each prompt's counterargument and your answer to it ("That is true to an extent. However...").
- ☐ At least 8 key terms you can drop in correctly: popular sovereignty, natural rights, social contract, checks and balances, Bill of Rights, amendment process, judicial review, Commerce Clause, Supremacy Clause.
- ☐ The natural rights backup from class: to a large extent, because power is divided and the 5th Amendment protects "life, liberty, or property", but at first only for some people. Answer the slavery counter with Article V and the 13th and 14th Amendments.

Tomorrow morning

- ☐ On the way in, read your three post-its once.
- ☐ Read page 1 of the test day memory jog.
- ☐ In class, spend the first 5 minutes outlining before you write anything.

Filled in versions to check against: cosmeticaura.github.io/government/Gov-essay-worksheets.pdf

Collaborative essay practice

Prompt 1: The founders' goals

Name _____ Date _____ Time it took _____

Prompt: What were the goals and priorities of the founders in drafting and ratifying the Constitution?

Step 1: Analyze the prompt. Rewrite it in your own words, then underline the key words in the prompt above and label them (who, what, evaluation).

Step 2: Identify the three options you can argue. Not a "to what extent" prompt. Write the three main answers you could give.

Option 1: _____

Option 2: _____

Option 3: _____

Circle the option you'll argue.

Step 3:

Gather evidence before deciding which side to argue.

	Evidence	**Which option from step 2 does this support, and why?**
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

Step 4: draft your response

Prompt 1: The founders' goals

Context: Background that shows why the topic matters: who, what, where, when, why. At least 3 connected sentences before the thesis.

Thesis: [Claim] because [Supporting argument 1] and [Supporting argument 2].

Evidence 1, TEA: Topic sentence, then evidence (facts, dates, clauses, cases), then analysis: why it matters and how it proves the thesis.

Evidence 2, TEA: Topic sentence, evidence, analysis.

Alternative perspective, TEA: "Critics argue...", their evidence, then why your argument is still stronger ("That is true to an extent. However...").

Conclusion: The thesis in new words, plus why it matters.

Check: thesis has a claim and two reasons ☐ each body paragraph ends with analysis ☐ 8+ key terms ☐ counterargument answered ☐

Collaborative essay practice

Prompt 2: How democracy evolved

Name _____ Date _____ Time it took _____

Prompt: How has American democracy evolved?

Step 1: Analyze the prompt. Rewrite it in your own words, then underline the key words in the prompt above and label them (who, what, evaluation).

Step 2: Identify the three options you can argue. Not a "to what extent" prompt. Write three ways you could describe the change.

Option 1: _____

Option 2: _____

Option 3: _____

Circle the option you'll argue.

Step 3:
Gather evidence before deciding which side to argue.

	Evidence	**Which option from step 2 does this support, and why?**
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

Step 4: draft your response

Prompt 2: How democracy evolved

Context: Background that shows why the topic matters: who, what, where, when, why. At least 3 connected sentences before the thesis.

Thesis: [Claim] because [Supporting argument 1] and [Supporting argument 2].

Evidence 1, TEA: Topic sentence, then evidence (facts, dates, clauses, cases), then analysis: why it matters and how it proves the thesis.

Evidence 2, TEA: Topic sentence, evidence, analysis.

Alternative perspective, TEA: "Critics argue...", their evidence, then why your argument is still stronger ("That is true to an extent. However...").

Conclusion: The thesis in new words, plus why it matters.

Check: thesis has a claim and two reasons ☐ each body paragraph ends with analysis ☐ 8+ key terms ☐ counterargument answered ☐

Collaborative essay practice

Prompt 3: The 21st century

Name _____ Date _____ Time it took _____

Prompt: To what extent is the Constitution serving Americans' needs in the 21st century?

Step 1: Analyze the prompt. Rewrite it in your own words, then underline the key words in the prompt above and label them (who, what, evaluation).

Step 2: Identify the three options you can argue. A "to what extent" prompt. Write three places on the spectrum, from great extent to very little.

Option 1: _____

Option 2: _____

Option 3: _____

Circle the option you'll argue.

Step 3:
Gather evidence before deciding which side to argue.

	Evidence	**Which option from step 2 does this support, and why?**
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

Step 4: draft your response

Prompt 3: The 21st century

Context: Background that shows why the topic matters: who, what, where, when, why. At least 3 connected sentences before the thesis.

Thesis: [Claim] because [Supporting argument 1] and [Supporting argument 2].

Evidence 1, TEA: Topic sentence, then evidence (facts, dates, clauses, cases), then analysis: why it matters and how it proves the thesis.

Evidence 2, TEA: Topic sentence, evidence, analysis.

Alternative perspective, TEA: "Critics argue...", their evidence, then why your argument is still stronger ("That is true to an extent. However...").

Conclusion: The thesis in new words, plus why it matters.

Check: thesis has a claim and two reasons ☐ each body paragraph ends with analysis ☐ 8+ key terms ☐ counterargument answered ☐